MODERN NINJITSU

Rick Tew's Martial Science



PHILOSOPHY AND SYSTEM

Sensei Rick Tew


RICK TEW'S
MIND
BODY
SPIRIT
MARTIAL SCIENCE

Ryu spirit does not live only in the papers that help form its existence.



The spirit is alive through the growth and sharing of its members. That is why it is a Ryu: a group of elite individuals bound by a purpose that each of them shares. Even though the Ryu believes in the views set down by the Ryu Master, the Ryu is just as important as its founder. If you are a part of the Ryu, then you are a part of its existence. You are not simply a student of a martial art, you are a member of the family. If you help it grow, you will develop as well. This growth can be spiritual, physical, and personal. Students who plant the seeds of growth will pick the fruit of its reward.





In the system of Rick Tew's Martial Science, you will learn many skills that are not taught in most martial arts. It is not limited to the approach of having any number of set kata or self-defense techniques. Tew's total training consists of techniques that teach you how to be prepared. Preparation for a realistic combat situation will not arrive through traditional or old-style martial arts practice. A well-prepared warrior is ready to face all types of situations. How can a martial art call itself a practical form of self-defense when it sets its own limitations?



Setting the Stage

Most practitioners of martial arts never leave the comfort of the mat, and therefore repeat techniques in a non-changing environment. By doing this, they will be preparing themselves for only a set context. The RTMS practitioner, on the other hand, will find himself with a variety of challenges in many areas, both mental and physical. Students will find each class unique while still getting the essential growth toward a natural use of mind, body, and spirit. Because of our versatility, students won't become bored with the necessary and repetitious training.

RTMS is not just a combination of many arts that make it into its elite system. Though it has a background in forms such as *Ninjitsu, Kickboxing,* and *Tae kwon do*, it surpasses the limitations of these arts. RTMS is what Ninjitsu would like to be: realistic, practical, effective, and fun to learn. There are no limitations such as having a "Ninja punch" which would limit the versatility of a Total Warrior. The Total Warrior uses information as an **instrument for development, not as a rule**. It encompasses the best of all skills to benefit the purpose of building mind, body, and spirit. This system is not in the business of pumping out black belts for commercialism. If you hold a rank in the Martial Science, it is because you earned it.

- Flexibility and Breathing
- Physical Fitness and Weight Loss
- Food and Diet
- Visualization And Meditation
- Principles of Combat
- Hand to Hand / Weapon Training
- Gymnastics and Stunt Technique
- Business and Success
- Kicking and Punching
- Ground Fighting and Grappling
- Mental Strategies for Success
- Mind Control and Memory Skills
- Weapon and Training Tools
- Travel Programs and Camps

RTMS is not limited to the above guideline. To list or label the training you will be receiving is impossible if we are to keep from setting limitations on our ability. This guideline is simply a cloud that hangs over the world of RTMS.

What is the Martial Science?

RTMS is a combination of Ninjitsu and many other martial art systems. Because of the Ninjitsu affiliations, I often stumble across a few confused practitioners of so-called "traditional" Ninjitsu. The following will explain what the Martial Science IS and what it is NOT.

It is not an art form

A typical martial art has already decided what makes up that style. The style, be it *Tae Kwon Do*, *Wing Chun*, *Hapkido*, *Aikido,* or *Judo,* is already packaged. When the student arrives, it is the job of the instructor to teach him/her this package and have him/her mold to its specifications. This is the biggest reason we are not a Martial **Art**. Instead, we are a Science that develops around the package of the student instead of making attempts at creating monotonous warriors.

NOTE

More information on RTMS and other programs can be found throughout this book or on our web site at www.TotalWarrior.com

It is my belief that the man makes the art and not the other way

around. This is to say that even though basic Karate is not a very realistic system for self-defense, it doesn't mean there can't be very deadly Karatekas. There are some people who just do well no matter what style you put them in. However, with the Martial Science and its concept to develop around the individual, it makes it easier for the System to actually improve the student. Why? Because the student IS the style.

There are No Limitations

Black Belts are not what they used to be. Because RTMS doesn't set limitations on its students, they are allowed to develop at a much faster rate. **This rate is at least 3 times faster than the average school.** A normal karate student will go into class and be forced into the mindset that he/she is only a white belt and must perform as such. Students come into the Martial Science knowing they wear a gray belt, but are only at the level at which they (as individuals) choose to be. This is hard to explain, but an important factor in the students' growth. Of course there is a required amount of common sense involved; you can't have beginners doing high-diving rolls and wall flips during their first class.



In the traditional school, the student has a hard time advancing because he/she is caged and limited by his/her own system. We try to avoid this trap and get the student on to higher skill levels.

Many people might think that the student would end up advancing without a strong foundation in the basics; after all, the basics are what build the structure of a master. This is not the case in the Martial Science. We have a unique way of training students for advancement.

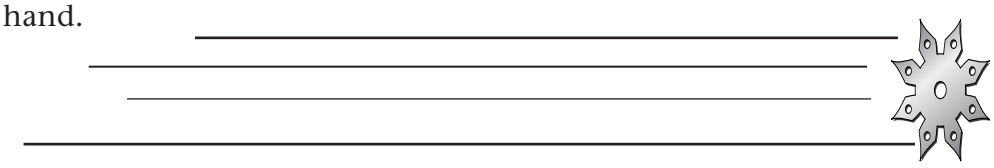
Realistic - Reality of Fiction



Another key point to bring out into the open is realism. And this goes for Ninjitsu as well as most other martial arts. We try to maintain a focused realistic approach to training. **Thus, you won't find RTMS instructors teaching students to defend against a reverse punch or have them standing in line punching over and over while chanting numbers.** We do have basic training, but it is fun and flexible. We maintain authority and discipline without having to degrade the student. We believe in teaching (or putting back the "SELF" in) SELF-discipline. Self means that YOU want to do it and not just that someone is screaming at you for more push-ups.

Realistic to me is simple and to the point: How would someone on the street punch you? How would you react or respond? I don't see many people punching the way most schools teach - so to me, this is silly.

Even though we focus on realism, we also understand the martial arts is a place to have fun. So I will teach techniques that I know won't work in a fight, but I will tell my students beforehand that this is to develop a certain kick or type of body movement. I would rather use my hands than have a pair of nunchakus, but I love to play with them and this is part of the Martial Science. **We like to include as much as possible to train a student in all facets of the arts while still getting serious training.** Also, when we teach specific defenses against a punch or kick, we explain to the students that this is training and not a defense against a punch or a kick. Too many students are taught to believe they will react with technique 1 or 2 from their list of learned skills. This concept is ridiculous and unrealistic. Every single attack is completely different and all the skills (and defenses) you learn are simply pieces of a puzzle. When you get into a situation, you will utilize these learned movements and adapt to the situation at hand.

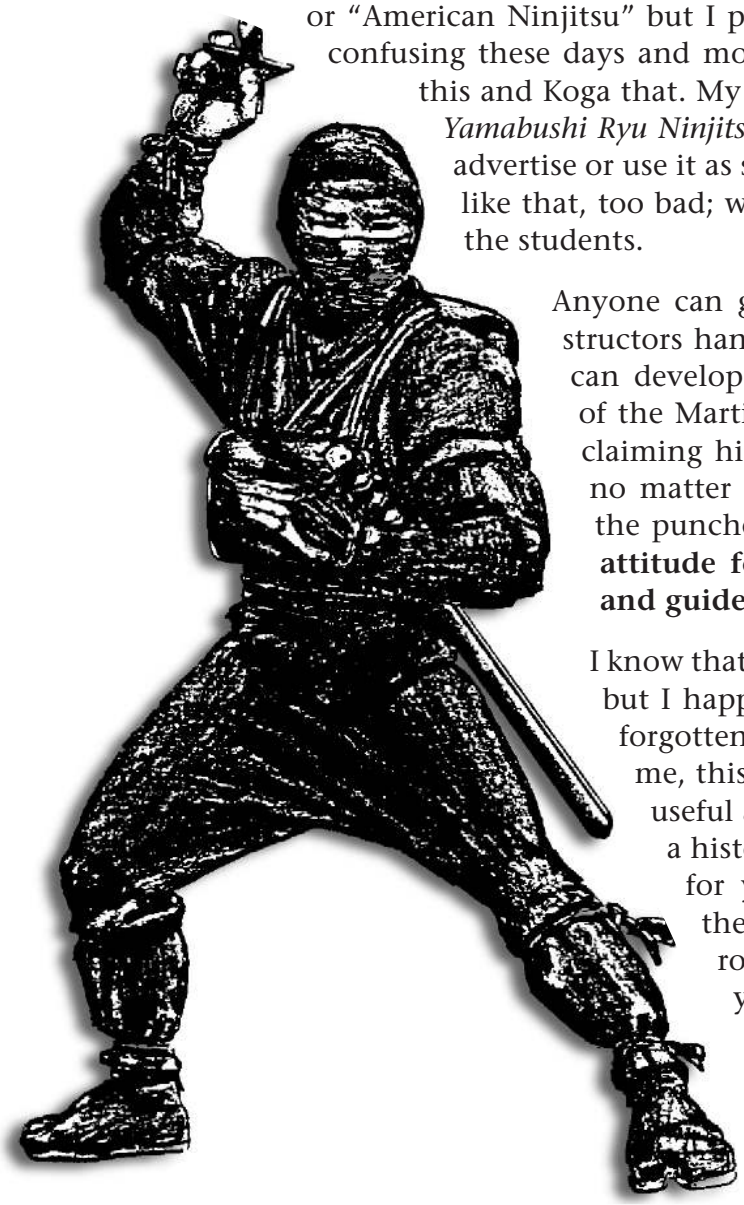


You have to understand that your opponent is not going to throw one punch and wait for you to defend yourself. **Your opponent is also not going to leave that punch out there while you dance around.** Most schools teach a one-two defense strategy. In the street, the adrenaline is flowing and, like it or not, punching someone in the wrist is ONLY a way to interrupt their pattern (if they even feel it). Some people can be kicked in the groin and still not notice what has happened. This is why realistic training is important. So many students think they can defend themselves because they do well in class. **But in class, the adversary is taught to go down.** Now I am not saying I want you to be a pain in the butt when your partner is doing techniques. In training, you can't actually kick them in the groin. But you CAN offer resistance and realistic movements and responses to your partners' moves.

Ninjitsu and the Martial Science

Now the big issue is the Ninjitsu and Martial Science factor. The reason I call it the Martial Science is because it is the new age of ninjitsu. It is what Ninjitsu wants to be or claims to be. I am tired of the goofy ninja clans trying to take over the world with their silly concepts and totally unrealistic training. I know there are a few out there who have a clue as to what is going on, but I have done more than enough research and have more than enough people to back me up on all of this. So if you want to be a so-called "ninja" of some mysterious past, then by all means, continue to fan the flame of the goofy guys. **But, if you want reality and real martial arts training, then that is what we are here for**. We clear the clouds of mysticism and bring ninjutsu back down to earth.

Ninjutsu tries to claim that it is a complete art; it also claims to be realistic. But the only thing it has that truly speaks this is the literature. **Performance is something else entirely.** We don't make any claims whatsoever towards being associated with the goofy ninja clans. We are not gurus and we do not push any religious beliefs. **We teach the student to worship themselves along with their individual beliefs.** We could be called, "New Age Ninjitsu," or "American Ninjitsu" but I prefer the Martial Science. Ninjitsu is too confusing these days and most people are lost in the transcripts. Iga this and Koga that. My personal association is through the *Koga Yamabushi Ryu Ninjitsu* tradition, and I don't feel any need to advertise or use it as some sort of qualification. If people don't like that, too bad; we are not here for them. We are here for the students.



Anyone can get a certificate, and many Ninjutsu instructors hand them out every day. But not everyone can develop the skill to become a true practitioner of the Martial Science. It does not limit students by claiming historical beginnings. A punch is a punch no matter where it came from. You can't reinvent the punches and kicks. **You can simply create an attitude for achievement: a set of philosophies and guidelines**.

I know that many people want a huge history lesson, but I happen to be one of those people who have forgotten half of what they learned in school. To me, this means that I would rather learn what is useful and what will apply to my life. If you are a history buff, then the Martial Science is NOT for you. If you want to worship someone, then it is NOT for you. If you want an easy road to black belt, then it is NOT for you. If you want the instructors to spice up every technique by saying this is Koppojutsu, Taihenjutsu or Tachi Waza, then this system is NOT for you.

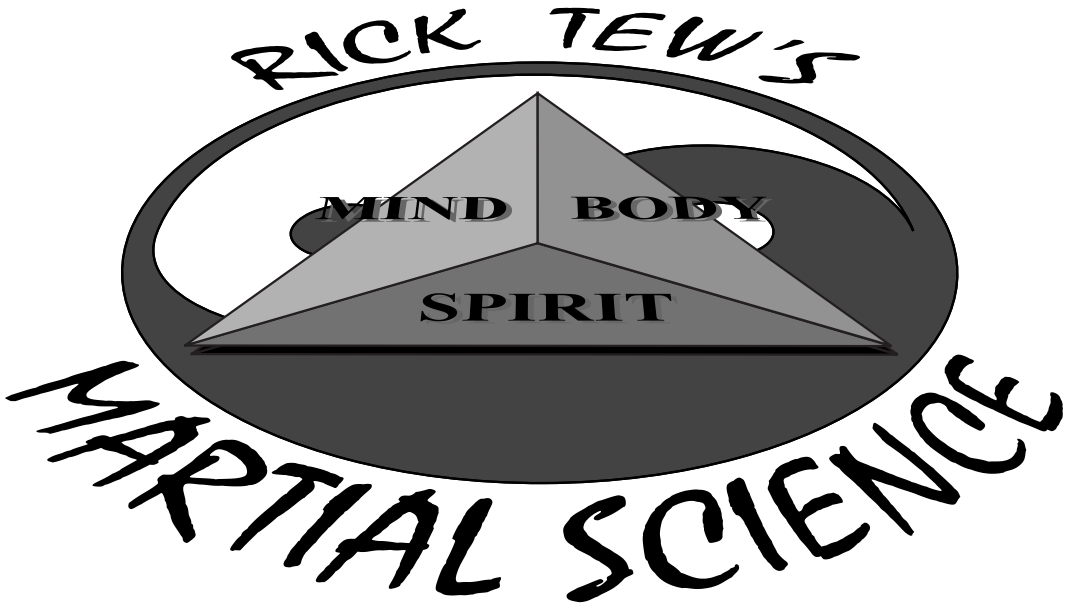
However, if you want an instructor who is more of a friend, a peer and a coach--if you want to work hard for you skills and earn a real black belt, if you want to avoid the politics and actually become a real participant in the organization, if you want realistic training with the real guidelines and a system from grey to black, if you want this and programs that real martial artists can afford, then the Martial Science IS for you. For everyone else, there are plenty of schools to choose from.

Understanding the RTMS Logo

The logo is comprised of three parts:

Balance – Yin Yang Symbol Mind, Body and Spirit Triangle

Rick Tew's Martial Science Text



Balance

The Yin Yang symbol set in the background of the logo stands for balance. Just as it rests in the background of our logo – it should rest in the background of your life.

Balance is important in creating and maintaining the healthy successful lifestyle that we desire; balance in who we are, what we do, and who we do it with. The difficulty with maintaining a happy lifestyle is that we often times take things to the extreme (be it love, work or adventure). I have been on both sides of the lifestyle beam and find joy and excitement from each end. I have also found that running from one end of the beam to the other to keep a balance, really only keeps us in a constant state of chaos. This chaos is when we are just struggling with last minute survival tactics. Sure, there are good times and bad times, but they are enveloped in a constant stressful environment.

With balance we can enjoy the best of both worlds and still maintain a happy thriving lifestyle.

Mind, Body and Spirit Triangle



Each side represents an area we wish to develop for our own total self worth. The left side represents the mind where all our knowledge and skill is given birth. The right is a representation of the body and physical skills. The bottom is the spirit of all that we are and strive to become.

THE MIND:

A warrior is a strategist and a thinker. To be intelligent, one must strive to increase knowledge and gain wisdom. This is what separates a martial art from a martial science. RTMS practitioners want results and they get those by learning what works and what does not. When building our minds we strive to increase the following four areas:

KNOWLEDGE
Arts - Skills - Facts

MENTAL ARTS
Imagery - Meditation - Success

UNDERSTANDING
Science - Foundation - Clarity

ATTITUDE
Confidence - Discipline - Optimism

At RTMS we also teach the "Mind Martial Science." It is the training program that teaches the mental skills for ultimate performance. It is the realistic approach to mind control. Understanding the way the brain works and being able to communicate using mind language. With these skills, you are able to have a powerful mental attitude, master your motivation, increase your memory and control your emotional state.

THE BODY:



Healthy mind = healthy body, our mind gives us the dedication to keep our bodies fit and strong. A Warrior must learn to control his body and treat it with respect. We perform exercises that build strength and to increase stamina for internal and external fitness. We exercise proper eating habits that keep the temple of our souls clean and free of toxins.

Probably the most attractive reason people get into RTMS. The body symbolizes all of our physical skills. This makes up most of today's martial arts. The kicks, punches, rolls, falls and other movements fall under the category for body. This also includes developing healthy physiques, eating right, breathing, stretching exercises and yes... wearing sunscreen. Anything that is physical or concerns your body is important.



THE SPIRIT:

To us, spirit is the center of focus for most of our training. Spirit isn't just the group atmosphere you get with your class. It isn't just the spiritual emotions that arise when you walk through the trees. It is the combination of team spirit, the outdoors and living the life you enjoy. These things are important in creating a well-rounded individual, which is what the Martial Science is all about. It isn't just about being on a team or being involved with a sport. It is about living the way.

Getting up each day living the life you enjoy is part of the spirit. Spending time with friends and having adventure in the outdoors is also spirit. Without spirit, there is no life. Not everyone wants to sit behind a desk all day waiting for their life to pass them by. Not everyone wants to wake up each day only to regret the last. And not everyone wants to keep wishing they had more to gain from daily activities.

Panther, Dragon and Eagle

PATH OF THE PANTHER – BEGINNER LEVEL

Once you have attained your gray belt you will enter into the first level of training. The panther is the symbol of the knowledge we need to gain as a foundation for our training. In training as a panther you will learn to build strength, speed, control, and body movement skills. The path of the panther will give you all your basic information and a foundation for a complete understanding of the system.



TIME OF THE DRAGON LEVEL INTERMEDIATE

The dragon is the symbol of your creativity and imagination. As a dragon you will learn to develop your own movements based on your personal strengths and weaknesses. You will already have an understanding of the basics and it will now be time to learn to integrate all your knowledge.

FLIGHT OF THE EAGLE LEVEL ADVANCED

The eagle is the symbol of leadership and the time to learn the skills necessary to harness your knowledge through teaching. A red belt is a level of instructor's status. At this level you are now allowed to teach within RTMS and start your path to black belt. It will usually be a period of three years after you have reached your instructors status to become a black belt.

Rick Tew's Martial Science Text

Everything we have discussed above is enclosed in the system of Rick Tew's Martial Science. Rick Tew is the founder of the organization. Ryu is you and all of your fellow members. The Martial Science is the philosophy that we follow set down by Sensei Rick Tew and its members.

The "Martial" and the "Art"



BALANCE: THE BEST OF BOTH WORLDS - A VIEW ON TRAINING

Okay, so we all have heard the word "Martial Art" before. But, you will notice that we avoid using the term "Martial Art" to describe our system. Instead, we call it the "Martial Science." Why? Well, because our system is called the Martial Science--that's why. Just as you would call something Karate, Kung-fu, or even Ninjitsu, we call it Martial Science. Still, it is and always will be a Martial Art.

Okay, now that we have cleared that up, I would like to talk about the Martial Arts and why I believe it is important. To me, the Martial Arts is a concept that explains balance in the system of Martial Science. To most, the Martial Arts is an umbrella word for systems of self-defense. But in RTMS we focus on my definition, what I consider to be *a philosophy of Martial Arts.*

To me, it is all about balance. And my definition (or a rough draft of it) of balance is something that offers a variety or both sides of the coin. To understand this, we will need to break up the word Martial Arts into two parts, the first being Martial and the second being Arts. Okay, now that we have some division, let's analyze each part:

THE MARTIAL

This word is the symbol of realistic self-defense and combat. Martial is another word for Military and since we all have somewhat confused feelings about the military, we will just stick with Martial. Martial is that part that focuses on reality, not fiction. In other words, you won't call a jumping-flying-spinning back kick a martial tactic. In a painful reality, combat really is, well . . . "combat."



Combat isn't sparring, dancing, fancy techniques or all that other stuff some instructors will swear by. It is very important to have a martial understanding when training in any system of self-defense. I hate to break the news to you, but most systems have no idea of what is or what isn't going to work on the street. Most of the techniques, arm locks, wrist takedowns, and fancy kicks will not work in a real fight. They will assist in combat when developing the puzzle of natural responses, but they will not work the same as they do when practiced in the dojo.

Now there is a level of control involved with practice and there is an edge to be gained when you distract your opponent. This will assist in helping you perform, but it will still be a far cry from the way you perform techniques in class to the way you react on the street.

So a mental understanding is the first step to developing your martial abilities: *knowing what will and will not work and using this as a foundation for development.* The next step would be to actually learn some reality-based combat techniques. A lot of systems offer a great variety of these skills. For example:



FIGHT SCENE

You drop into a horse stance preparing for the fight. You side kick before the punch is thrown. It looks cool and stuns your adversary. The opponent reacts with a straight punch and you high block, and then throw a reverse punch to the solar plexus. Your opponent is immobilized so you jump into a spinning back kick. This knocks your opponent to the ground and finishes the fight.

Okay let's use some reality: You drop into a side horse stance preparing for the fight. Since you are in a very unrealistic stance, your opponent sweeps your leg right out from under you and you fall on your butt.



The opponent throws a punch and you high block and then throw a punch to the solar plexus. You hit your opponent in the solar plexus (great shot), but it didn't cause the same result you get in class, so the attacker hits you with a hook punch with his other hand. Too bad you don't practice defenses against multiple punches. "Ouch."

You jump into a spinning back kick for the extra power. You miss and land as your ankle twists and you fall onto your back. Your opponent takes the fight to the ground. You end in a choke out. – fade to black.

Coming to an understanding of reality is key when considering developing your martial skills. Once you have both the mental understanding and the techniques to practice - you will then need to get in some *action* . Action includes getting a taste of the medicine. And the medicine is: sparring, grappling, give and takes and reaction attack.

Sparring will train you to work on your defenses and timing. You should have full protective gear and go full contact, *under the guidance of an instructor, of course.* A good way to get in a great sparring session is to work 10 minutes on each of the following areas:

1. Hands Only
2. Feet Only
3. Grappling Only
4. Anything Goes

Just be sure and keep the fight injury down to a reasonable level. Don't play, but also don't try to kill your opponent.



Grappling drills work on specific situations to enhance your ground fighting skills. These include scenarios and targeted workouts.



Give and takes are drills that are designed to toughen your body while developing your awareness. You start facing your opponent to work the offensive. You throw any kick or punch at your opponent and he or she either blocks or takes the attack (usually it is a take). The opponent then takes a step back and you continue until you throw about 10 strikes or kicks. Then it is your opponent's turn to attack. When you are on the defense, be sure to pay attention to the way your opponent moves for each attack. Try to read the attacks and mentally prepare a response.



Reaction attack is a kind of full contact sparring session, only you won't feel like you are sparring. You face the class with full protective gear on each person. Suddenly, one of the class members attacks you full blast. This is where you react to the attack and start moving. This type of exercise will help you control your fear and better prepare you for a sudden attack situation.

Okay, that is a brief description of one half of the balance concerning the Martial Arts; here is the second half:

The Arts



With the popularity of full contact fighting competitions such as the UFC, many martial art systems are getting the very short end of the stick. I don't just mean that the grappler is kicking butt on every system out there, but many people are looking for dojos that train freestyle fight or reality-based street combat while ignoring the styles that teach more of the ART. It makes sense; why train in Tae-Kwon-Do when you want to learn to defend yourself in a realistic combat situation? This is the kind of question that is seeping into the minds of modern day students.

This is where the balance comes in. I believe that it is far more rewarding to train in both Martial and Art--equally. No matter how often I laugh at unrealistic techniques being taught in many schools, I will always train in the arts. The reason for this is that many of us are not just training for a combat situation. Training purely on street self-defense is not only limited, it can also get boring real quickly. I train in the Martial Science as a way to improve, not just survive a fight. I train to increase my flexibility, strengthen my muscles, improve my health, and enhance my overall ability. It is about being the best you can be, not just being a great ground fighter. To me, all the weapons, gymnastics, fancy kicks, and fun techniques are a great part of training. These are the things that make it fun.

We need to understand that martial arts training should be fun and not just a serious wake up call. If you are studying only to learn to protect yourself that is one thing, but if you are training to be the best you can be, then you cannot exclude the other areas that make a martial art what it is.

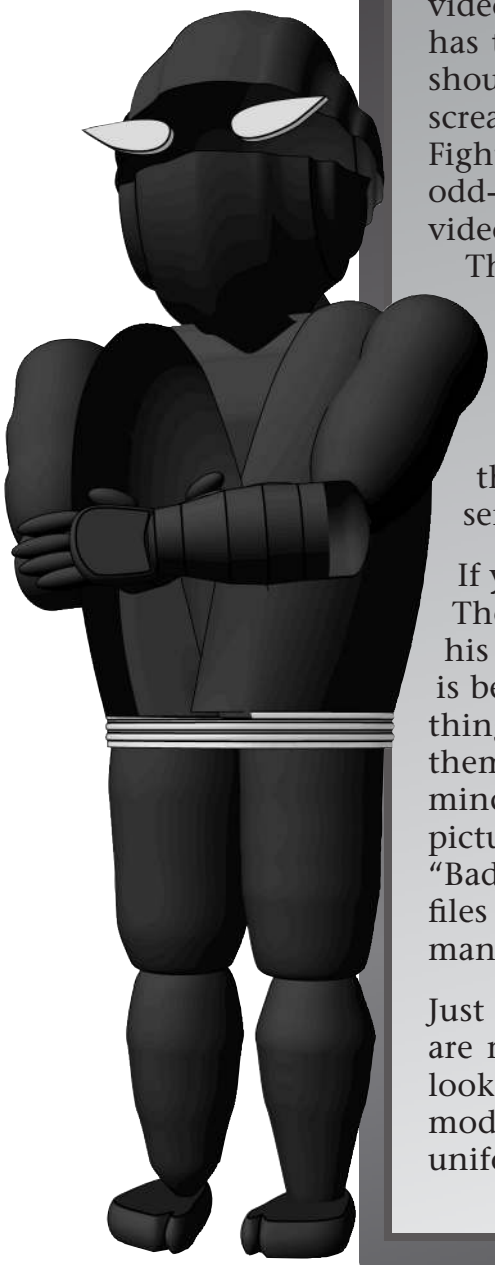


Just imagine how boring your favorite action films would be. Think of life without Jackie Chan and his awesome theatrical skills. Knives may be sharp in the street, but that is no reason to make your life dull in the dojo. I guess I am still a kid at heart and would rather play than kick trees with my shins. But understand that I believe in an equal balance of the two. Still, I believe that they go together and the two of them create my understanding of the Martial Arts.

Also, the martial arts is (or should be) a "Way of Life." This is hard to achieve if you are focused purely on street combat.

So ignore the people who make fun of your fancy skills (most of them are jealous) and kick the legs of those who don't understand reality over fancy moves. It is a double-edged sword and if you are anything like me, you will love swinging around that sword.

FIND A WAY



Browsing through the May issue of **Black Belt** magazine, I came across a very goofy advertisement. It is a video sale ad from Panther Productions on page 12. It has this guy on the page named "Wallid Ismail." You should have heard about him because he never stops screaming how his Jujutsu beat world famous Ultimate Fighting Champion Royce Gracie. Aside from the very odd-looking face Wallid makes in these photos, the videos are probably very informative and instructional. That isn't my concern.

My concern is all the hype and commercialism that goes into these events and into the so- called "Masters" of all these newly discovered Brazilian Jujutsu styles. It isn't about Jujutsu, Brazil. or even the artists. It is about the way things are being presented--even by **Black Belt** magazine.

If you get a chance, take a look at the advertisement. The first photo (top left) is a standing Mr. Ismail with his big trophy belts. One he is wearing and the other is being held over his right arm These belts aren't the things that made me laugh; in fact, I didn't even notice them until later. The first thing that popped into my mind when seeing these pictures was "RACE CAR." The picture makes him look like a logo-plastered race car. "Bad Boy," "Team Panther," and more company profiles are draped onto the uniform like a person with too many tattoos. *"Uh, hey Wallid, do you need a sponsor?"*

Just look at all the photos in this advertisement--they are ridiculous. If you don't have the Black Belt ad to look at, just imagine a kid with too many left over model car decals that he places all over his white Judo uniform.



My concern isn't so much the advertising or the support of an otherwise starving martial artist. It is on the powerful view the people and media seem to have on this focus of combat and often called "martial art." To me it is closer to going to the movies. It is entertainment, but I wouldn't call it a martial art. Basically, most people watch the UFC for its entertainment value--not because they want to learn to grapple. It does very little for promoting true martial arts. Just to clarify, I am talking about the media interpretation and not the obvious validity of Jujutsu or other arts.

Although I fully agree that these events offer a realistic view of martial combat in the ring, I don't feel they offer a well-rounded benefit to the practitioner. Becoming a champion at something is a personal goal, not a global belief. Training should be thought of as a way to increase your overall skill level. All levels, that is. You can't argue that kicks are a waste of time because the combat practitioners of such full contact matches as the UFC have proven this to be true. You and 99% of the population are probably not training for an Ultimate Fighting Championship. Think of playing chess, video games, or sports. You are doing these because you enjoy them. You are not going to cancel these things out of your life just because you can't checkmate your opponent in real combat.

Life is and should be the center of attention. What you enjoy doing is the key. Just be sure to keep a practical and realistic view when it comes to combat. Use the UFC as an example for this knowledge: it is something you can add to your knowledge base, but not something to separate and use as a stand-alone concept of the Martial Arts.

In RTMS we view the entire system based on three very important principles. They are MIND, BODY, and SPIRIT. You probably have heard this before. However, with Rick Tew's the Martial Science, each of these things means a great deal to us and actually makes up the system.

The combination of Mind, Body, and Spirit creates a system based on the individual. This allows growth for your own goals and not those set down by the media or a current fad. This system lasts as long as you desire it to because it is a life-style and not just a style. It is a way of thinking, a way of using your body, and a way living life with spirit. It is your way.



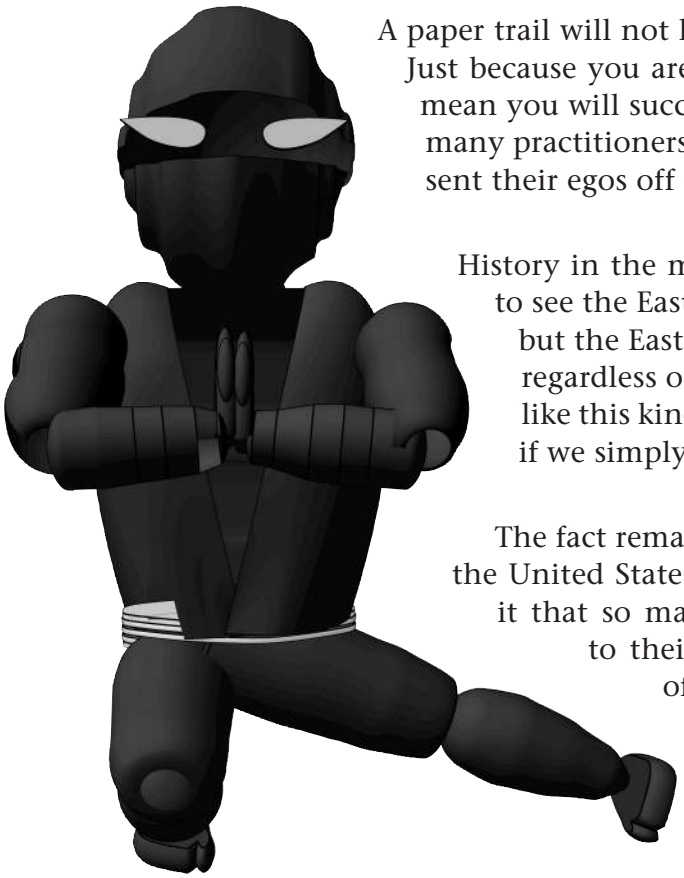
Having a style or system that is your way requires a system to offer you versatility. The system needs to be able to build around your own strengths and weaknesses. It needs to offer you a healthy membership as part of a real team and not just a bow down to master relationship. It requires fitting you into a lifestyle that makes you happy and fulfills your desires at the same time. Basically, it all sounds like something that is what every person needs, but this isn't the case. Remember, we are trying to avoid the global beliefs set down by the media or any other social force. We are simply opening up the individual choice to acquire something more than just an art or form of combat. That just isn't enough for something to call itself "a way of life." A way is not good enough for the individual. It has to be his/her way. This is why it is an individual and not global system. Some people will fit into the puzzle of the Martial Science while others won't. It isn't a question of good or bad. Society, the media, or masters with opinions don't regulate it. It is simply defined by what it offers the individual student. Are you happy with your training program or not?

After some time in the martial arts and gaining life experience, this information will become clear. At the moment it may not be easy to understand--as is the case with many things in life. Some things just need to be experienced. Realize that you are the master of your life. You are the guide and the only one who can truly teach you the skill of being happy. Find a "Way" that is "Your Way."

"Oh, East is East, and West is West, and never the twain shall meet, Till Earth and Sky stand presently at God's great Judgment Seat. But there is neither East or West, Border or Breed, nor Birth, When two strong men stand face to face, though they come from the ends of the earth!

- Rudyard Kipling

TRADITION – IS IT HISTORY?



A paper trail will not help you to survive a life or death situation. Just because you are born or bred as part of a lineage does not mean you will succeed either. Although it is an easy excuse for many practitioners of the martial arts, it is time the instructors sent their egos off to play with scrolls and labels.

History in the martial arts dictates that there is a tendency to see the East as the primary source of martial traditions, but the East does not have a monopoly on fighting arts, regardless of how much many master instructors would like this kind of control. We could start a tradition today if we simply practiced the concepts tomorrow.

The fact remains that many seeds have been brought into the United States only to flourish on American soil. How is it that so many Instructors claim an unbreakable bond to their tradition and history yet still try to pass off this influence in another country claiming that this country or its inhabitants have no right to claim its own tradition? If you read many of our articles, you will notice that we attempt to avoid these kinds of politics. We teach under the system of Martial Science--which happens to be an American System regardless of any monopolies or influence foreign instructors have on their students or the media. We believe it is "in the doing" and not the "have done" that matters.

Yes, many instructors seem to think they own the world when it comes to Ninjutsu or other martial traditions. Perhaps what many people don't realize is that it can all be broken down to simply a way of thinking. You cannot own a way of thinking and these Instructors seem to think they should control this area of physical and mental ability. This is ridiculous since we don't live in the 17th century, and just because something was invented in another country, doesn't mean it cannot be perfected in the United States. The martial arts or its tradition is not a dictatorship; no one man or system can claim it is the almighty answer to your martial prayers. Ninjutsu may have started its growth in India, then China and onto Japan, only to be fully recognized and developed in America. But many worshiped instructors refuse to let go or offer any kind of honest acknowledgments for our developments here in the US.

"Look to the future, Learn from the past, but always and forever – Live in the now."